

ENGLISH LANGUAGE

MODERN ENGLISH (891)

PAPER 1 (Theory)

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: Three Hours

Reading Time: Additional Fifteen Minutes

Instructions to Candidates

1. You are allowed an additional **fifteen minutes** for **only** reading the question paper.
2. You must **NOT** start writing during reading time.
3. This question paper has 5 printed pages.
4. It has **four** questions in all.
5. Answer **all** questions.
6. You are advised to spend not more than 45 minutes on Question 1, 55 minutes on Question 2, 30 minutes on Question 3 and 50 minutes on Question 4.
7. While answering Multiple Choice Questions in Question 4, you are required to write only **one** option as the answer.
8. You should begin each answer on a fresh page.
9. The intended marks for questions are given in brackets [].

Instruction to Supervising Examiner

1. Kindly read aloud the Instructions given on page 1 to all the candidates present in the examination hall.

Question 1

Write a composition (in approximately 400 – 450 words) on any one of the following subjects. [20]

(You are reminded that you will be rewarded for the orderly and coherent presentation of the matter, use of appropriate style and general accuracy of spelling, punctuation and grammar.)

- (i) A member of your family underwent an operation, and you spent the afternoon waiting in the hospital corridor for news. Describe the sights and sounds around you and the people who waited with you. Express your feelings when the doctor finally came out of the operation theatre.
- (ii) Your class was wrongly blamed for damage to costly equipment in the school laboratory. Narrate how the truth came out and what the experience taught you.
- (iii) Homework does more harm than good. Argue either FOR or AGAINST the given statement.
- (iv) Kindness
- (v) 'We make a living by what we get, but we make a life by what we give.' Present your reflections on this statement.
- (vi) Write an original short story that begins with the following words:
The bus had not moved for an hour when the stranger beside me ...

Question 2

- (i) You are a staff reporter for a leading daily newspaper. For over a week a severe heatwave has disrupted normal life in your district. Write a newspaper report in about 250 – 300 words, based on the following guidelines: [15]
- the dates and the temperatures recorded – the reasons given by the weather office – the areas and people worst affected – the effect on schools, hospitals and the supply of water and power – relief measures taken by the district administration – the advice issued by doctors and weather experts
- (ii) As the President of the Quiz Club of your school, you plan to host an inter-school quiz competition on the school premises. Write a proposal in not more than 150 words, stating the steps you would take to make it a success. [10]

Question 3

Answer subparts (i), (ii) and (iii).

- (i) Rewrite the following sentences according to the instructions given after each of them in brackets. [5]
- (a) The students were decorating the hall when the principal arrived.
(Begin: The hall ...)
- (b) "Please keep your phones switched off during the concert," the announcer said to the audience.
(Begin: The announcer requested ...)
- (c) She not only sings well but also paints beautifully.
(Begin: Besides ...)
- (d) The old man did not suspect that the parcel contained a gift from his son.
(Begin: Little ...)
- (e) I shall always remember the kindness of the nurse who looked after me.
(Use: forget)
- (ii) In the following sentences, replace the INCORRECT underlined words to make the sentences meaningful and grammatically correct. Do not copy the sentences. [5]
- (a) Thieves broke out the jeweller's shop last night and stole the necklaces.
- (b) Our old car broke into on the highway, and we had to push it to a garage.
- (c) Please keep up the grass; it has just been sown.
- (d) He walked so fast that I could hardly keep off with him.
- (e) The old poet passed out peacefully in his sleep at the age of ninety.
- (f) The hall was so hot that two students passed away and had to be revived with cold water.
- (g) It took her months to get by the loss of her pet dog.
- (h) We had very little money that year, but we somehow got over.
- (i) Please hand out your answer sheets to the invigilator before you leave the hall.
- (j) At the finishing line, volunteers handed in bottles of water to the tired runners.

- (iii) Fill in the blanks in the passage given below with the appropriate form of the verb given in brackets. Do not write the passage but write the verbs in the correct order. [5]

Nobody _____ (1) (enjoy) standing in a queue, yet most of us _____ (2) (spend) a surprising part of our lives in one. Over the years, however, I _____ (3) (come) to believe that waiting well is an art.

The true artist of the queue never _____ (4) (lose) his temper. He knows that the line beside his own will always move faster, and he has long since stopped _____ (5) (switch) from one to the other. Instead of _____ (6) (grumble), he carries a book, and he would rather _____ (7) (read) a chapter than count the heads in front of him.

Last week, at the railway booking office, I _____ (8) (watch) such an artist at work. He was an elderly gentleman who had _____ (9) (bring) a folding stool and a flask of tea. "I have been _____ (10) (wait) here since dawn," he told me cheerfully, "and I have finished two crossword puzzles."

Question 4

Read the passage given below and answer the questions (i), (ii) and (iii) that follow.

- (1) The call came at a quarter to midnight, in the middle of the worst storm of the monsoon. I had been the veterinary surgeon at the district animal hospital for exactly three weeks, and I had not yet learnt to sleep through the telephone. A man's voice, thin with worry, shouted down a crackling line that his buffalo had been trying to calve since the afternoon and could not, and would the new doctor please come to Dhulipara, on the far side of the river. 5
- (2) The ferry had stopped running for the night, so I drove the long way round, across the bridge and back along a mud track that the rain had turned into a river of its own. Twice the jeep slid into the ditch, and twice I dug it out with my hands. It was nearly two o'clock when my headlights found a small hut and a figure waving a hurricane lantern beside it. 10
- (3) The farmer's name was Haripada. He was a thin man of about sixty, soaked to the skin, and behind him, in a low shed of bamboo and straw, his buffalo lay on her side in the mud, groaning. His son, a boy of about twelve, crouched by her head, stroking her neck and murmuring to her as if she were a child. 15
- (4) 'She is all we have, Doctor,' Haripada said quietly. 'Her milk pays for the boy's school.'
- (5) I soaped my arm to the shoulder in a bucket of warm water that his wife had kept ready, and began to examine the buffalo. It did not take long to find the trouble. The calf was alive, but one of its forelegs was bent back at the knee, so that it could not pass. Every time the mother strained, she was only pushing it harder against the wall of her own body. 20
- (6) I asked the boy to hold the lantern close and his father to keep her head still. Then, between her contractions, I pushed the calf gently back, found the folded leg, cupped the tiny hoof in my palm so that it could not tear anything, and drew it forward until both feet lay side by side. My arm had gone numb and my back was burning, but at last the position was right. At the next contraction I pulled steadily on a rope looped round the calf's feet, and in a sudden slithering rush the calf lay on the straw. 25
- (7) It did not move. Its eyes were closed, and it was not breathing. Behind me I heard the boy begin to cry.
- (8) There was no time to think. I cleared the thick mucus from its nose and mouth with my fingers, then, with Haripada's help, lifted it by the hind legs to let the fluid drain 30

from its throat. I laid it down again and rubbed its ribs hard with a handful of straw. Nothing happened. As a last resort I did what the old vets used to do, and poured a little cold water from the bucket into its ear. The calf gave a violent shake of its head, coughed and drew a long, shuddering breath.

- (9) Within a minute it was struggling to lift its head. The buffalo, forgetting her own exhaustion, heaved herself round and began to lick it all over with her great rough tongue, making a low, contented sound deep in her throat. The boy stopped crying and started to laugh. 35
- (10) Afterwards Haripada's wife brought me tea, sweet and strong, in the only unchipped cup in the house. I learnt later that the sugar had been borrowed from a neighbour. When I rose to go, Haripada pressed a small cloth bundle into my hands. Inside were six eggs, still warm. I guessed that they were the family's breakfast, but I knew that to refuse them would be an insult. 40
- (11) The sky was turning grey when I climbed back into the jeep. The boy ran after me through the mud. 'Doctor Babu!' he shouted. 'We are calling her Bristi, because she came with the rain!' 45
- (12) I have delivered a great many calves since that night, in better weather and with better equipment. But whenever a young vet asks me why I have stayed in this work, which is so often cold, dirty and badly paid, I think of that shed, and a calf coughing into life, and a boy laughing in the lantern light. 50

(An original passage written for this sample paper)

- (i)(a) Find a single word from the passage that will exactly replace the underlined word or words in the following sentences. [3]

- (1) The old man spoke in a low, soft voice to the frightened horse until it grew calm.
- (2) After the marathon several runners collapsed from extreme tiredness.
- (3) In the icy wind his fingers soon became unable to feel anything.

- (i)(b) For each of the words given below, choose the correct sentence that uses the same word unchanged in spelling, but with a different meaning from that which it carries in the passage. [3]

(1) **line** (line 4)

- (A) The line was so bad that I could hardly hear what she was saying.
- (B) The children stood in a straight line outside the classroom.
- (C) The linesman raised his flag to signal a foul.
- (D) She called me on a crackling line from the airport.

(2) **shed** (line 13)

- (A) The trees shed their leaves early in that dry winter.
- (B) The bicycles were kept in a tin shed behind the house.
- (C) He stored the garden tools in the shed.
- (D) The snake was shedding its old skin.

(3) **resort** (line 32)

- (A) As a last resort, the family sold their land to pay the debt.
- (B) We spent our winter holidays at a resort in the hills.
- (C) Borrowing money from a stranger was her only resort.
- (D) The resorts along the coast were crowded all summer.

- (ii) Answer the following questions as briefly as possible in your own words.
- (a) Cite any two instances from the passage to show that Haripada's family was poor but generous. [2]
- (b) Briefly discuss any two themes of the passage. [2]
- (c) Why did the narrator accept the eggs, although he guessed that they were the family's breakfast? [2]
- (iii) Summarise the steps the narrator took to deliver the calf and bring it to life (paragraphs 5 to 9). [8]
You are required to write the summary in the grid form in about 100 words. The use of abbreviations and contractions will not be accepted. Failure to keep within the word limit will be penalised.

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